INTERACTION REDEFINED

The growth of wearables presents some very interesting opportunities to design new interfaces. Here's how you'll talk to your wearables.

One crucial challenge when designing any wearable device is the medium of human–computer interaction; in particular, how do we as users talk and give commands to our wearables? We use a User interface, of course.

A User Interface (or UI) commonly refers to a set of commands or menus for human users to interact with a computer system or program. This can be achieved via various mediums such as text, touch, voice, and so on (e.g. the mouse and keyboard driven UI of a PC). Well-designed user interfaces allow you to perform tasks efficiently and with minimal instructions or training.

While most examples of UIs would point to some visual/text-based system, owing to their size and often unconventional design, these traditional UI systems are often impractical for wearable tech. Imagine using a mouse and keyboard to control a digital watch or headset! Yeah. Not happening.

Fortunately, it is not uncommon to see researchers develop new and more intuitive ways of human–machine interaction. Voice commands, air gestures, and even neurological signals are being implemented as means of communicating with digital systems. This spells great news